

ANTHROPOLOGY

Overview

The ISU program in Anthropology is housed in the Department of World Languages and Cultures. (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/worldlanguagesandcultures/>)

Anthropology students develop a well-rounded professional education in cultural anthropology, archaeology, and biological anthropology. An undergraduate major in Anthropology can serve as the nucleus for a general liberal education, or as the prerequisite for graduate training qualifying a person for positions in (1) college and university teaching, (2) research, and (3) administrative and applied positions in government, development organizations, museums, and private businesses or corporations.

Anthropology majors may choose either a Bachelor of Arts or a Bachelor of Science degree, both of which require 36 credits in anthropology. A Bachelor of Arts degree is obtained by fulfilling the college general education requirements plus 6 additional credits in Area I (Arts and Humanities) or III (Social Sciences) or a combination of both. A Bachelor of Science degree is obtained by fulfilling the college general education requirements plus 6 additional credits in Area IIA (Mathematics) or IIB (Natural Sciences) or a combination of both. All students must also complete a minor or a second major as part of their degree requirements.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of the major in anthropology, students will be able to:

1. Explain what it means to be human through the study of culture and society, the biology and evolution of humans and other primates, and through the study of past human communities and material culture.
2. Demonstrate knowledge of the important historical and contemporary issues in the subdisciplines of archaeological, biological, and cultural anthropology.
3. Describe and evaluate local and global issues from an anthropological perspective.
4. Demonstrate an understanding of the value of cultural diversity.

Degree Requirements

Undergraduate students with majors in anthropology are required to take the following anthropology core courses:

ANTHR 2010	Introduction to Cultural Anthropology	3
ANTHR 2020	Human Origins	3
ANTHR 3060	Culture and Interpretation	3
ANTHR 3070	Biological Anthropology	3
ANTHR 3080	Archaeology	3
ANTHR 4500	Approaches in Anthropology	3

One of the following methods courses is required: 3

ANTHR 3190	Skeletal Biology	3
or ANTHR 3280 Archaeological Discovery and Analysis		
or ANTHR 4310 Ethnographic Methods		

In addition to the above, 15 ANTHR choice credits are required. 15

Communication Proficiency requirement: According to the university-wide Communication Proficiency Grade Requirement (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#communicationproficiencytext>), students must demonstrate their communication proficiency by earning a grade of a C or better in ENGL 2500 Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition.

ENGL 2500	Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition	3
or ENGL 2500H Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition: Honors		

Additionally, the Anthropology Program requires a grade of C or better in one of the following courses:

ENGL 3020	Business Communication	
ENGL 3090	Proposal and Report Writing	
ENGL 3140	Technical Communication	

The principal sub-disciplines of anthropology are represented by the following:

1. Cultural anthropology:

ANTHR 2010	Introduction to Cultural Anthropology	3
ANTHR 2300	Globalization and the Human Condition	3
ANTHR 3060	Culture and Interpretation	3
ANTHR 3090	Introduction to Culture and Language	3
ANTHR 3100	Environmental Anthropology	3
ANTHR 3130	Kinship and Marriage in a Global Perspective	3
ANTHR 3220	Peoples and Cultures of Native North America	3
ANTHR 3230C	Latin American Anthropology: Race, Class and Gender	3
ANTHR 3230D	Latin American Anthropology: Regional Focus	3
ANTHR 3320A	Current Issues in Native North America: Gender and Family	3
ANTHR 3320B	Current Issues in Native North America: Indigenous Ecologies and Geographies	3
ANTHR 3320C	Current Issues in Native North America: Cultural and Political Movements	3
ANTHR 3320D	Current Issues in Native North America: Regional Focus	3
ANTHR 3360	Culture and Capitalism	3
ANTHR 3400	Magic, Witchcraft, and Religion	3

ANTHR 3540	War and the Politics of Humanitarianism	3
ANTHR 3550	Understanding Sub-Saharan Africa	3
ANTHR 4110	Anthropology in Professional Applications	3
ANTHR 4190B	Topics in Cultural Anthropology: Methods	3
ANTHR 4190C	Topics in Cultural Anthropology: Regional Focus	3
ANTHR 4190D	Topics in Cultural Anthropology: Others	3
ANTHR 4310	Ethnographic Methods	3
ANTHR 4340B	Internship: Cultural Anthropology	2-6
ANTHR 4340D	Internship: Linguistic Anthropology	2-6
ANTHR 4500	Approaches in Anthropology	3
ANTHR 4510B	Practicum in Anthropology: Cultural Anthropology	1-3
ANTHR 4510D	Practicum in Anthropology: Linguistic Anthropology	1-3
ANTHR 4900B	Independent Study: Cultural Anthropology	1-5
ANTHR 4900D	Independent Study: Linguistic Anthropology	1-5

2. Archaeology:

ANTHR 2020	Human Origins	3
ANTHR 3080	Archaeology	3
ANTHR 3120	Evolution of the Human Diet	3
ANTHR 3150	Archaeology of North America	3
ANTHR 3200	Great Plains Archaeology	3
ANTHR 3210	World Prehistory	3
ANTHR 3280	Archaeological Discovery and Analysis	3
ANTHR 4340A	Internship: Archaeology	1-6
ANTHR 4500	Approaches in Anthropology	3
ANTHR 4510A	Practicum in Anthropology: Archaeology	1-3
ANTHR 4900A	Independent Study: Archaeology	1-5

3. Biological Anthropology:

ANTHR 2020	Human Origins	3
ANTHR 3070	Biological Anthropology	3
ANTHR 3120	Evolution of the Human Diet	3
ANTHR 3170	Primate Behavior, Ecology, and Evolution	3
ANTHR 3190	Skeletal Biology	3
ANTHR 4340C	Internship: Biological Anthropology	1-6
ANTHR 4450	Biological Field School	4-6
ANTHR 4510C	Practicum in Anthropology: Biological Anthropology	1-3
ANTHR 4900C	Independent Study: Biological Anthropology	1-5

As majors in the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, Anthropology students must meet College of Liberal Arts and Sciences (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/>

#iastatecollegeofliberalartsandsciences) and University-wide requirements (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegescurricula/>) for graduation in addition to those stated above for the major.

LAS majors require a minimum of 120 credits, including a minimum of 45 credits at the 3000/4000 level. You must also complete the LAS world language requirement and career proficiency requirement.

Students in all ISU majors must complete a three-credit course in U.S. Cultures and Communities and a three-credit course in International Perspectives. Check U.S. Cultures and Communities and International Perspectives (<https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/us-cultures-and-communities-and-international-perspectives/>) for a list of approved courses.

Students in Anthropology have the option of pursuing a B.S. or a B.A. A B.S. requires six additional group requirement credits in natural science or mathematics disciplines. A B.A. requires six additional group requirement credits in social or humanities disciplines.

Anthropology B.S., B.A.

Freshman

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500	3 ANTHR 2020	3
LIB 1600	1 Minor choice	3
ANTHR 2010	3 Social science choice	3
Elective	3 Natural science choice	3
Arts & Humanities choice	3 Arts & Humanities choice	3
Social science choice	3	
	16	15

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ANTHR 3080	3 ANTHR 3060	3
World Languages and Cultures/International Perspective	4 World Languages and Cultures/International Perspective	4
Humanities choice	3 ANTHR 3000 choice	3
ENGL 2500	3 Minor choice	3
ANTHR 3000 choice	3 Natural science choice	3
LAS 2030	1	
	17	16

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ANTHR 4250	1 ANTHR 3070	3
STAT 1010	4 ENGL 3000-level	3
Arts & Humanities choice	3 ANTHR 3000	3

ANTHR 3000 choice	3 Minor choice	3
Natural science choice	3 Additional Area requirement	3
Summer: It is highly recommended that students complete a field school, internship, or study abroad experience during the summer between their junior and senior years however, this is not required for graduation.		
		14

Senior		15
Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ANTHR 4500	3 ANTHR 3000 choice	3
Minor choice	3 Minor choice	3
ANTHR 3000 choice	3 Elective	3
Additional Area requirement	3 Elective	3
Electives	3	
		15

Minor

A minor in anthropology consists of at least 15 credits. The minor must include at least 3 credits that are not used to meet any other department, college, or university requirement.

ANTHR 2010	Introduction to Cultural Anthropology	3
ANTHR 2020	Human Origins	3

One of the following in cultural anthropology (3 credits)

ANTHR 3060	Culture and Interpretation	3
or ANTHR 3090 Introduction to Culture and Language		
or ANTHR 3220 Peoples and Cultures of Native North America		
or ANTHR 3230 Latin American Anthropology: Regional Focus		
or ANTHR 3400 Magic, Witchcraft, and Religion		
or ANTHR 4190 Topics in Cultural Anthropology: Methods		
or ANTHR 4190 Topics in Cultural Anthropology: Regional Focus		
or ANTHR 4190 Topics in Cultural Anthropology: Others		

One of the following in archaeology or biological anthropology (3 credits)

ANTHR 3070	Biological Anthropology	3
or ANTHR 3080 Archaeology		
or ANTHR 3120 Evolution of the Human Diet		
or ANTHR 3150 Archaeology of North America		
or ANTHR 3190 Skeletal Biology		

or ANTHR 3210 World Prehistory	
Three additional credits in ANTHR at the 3000+ level	3

The Anthropology Undergraduate Minor is an LAS Minor. In addition to University policies governing minors (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>), LAS minors require at least 6 credits in courses numbered 3000 and above, with a grade of C or higher.

Graduate Programs

The department offers a master of arts degree with a major in anthropology. Graduate courses are offered in the areas of archaeology, biological anthropology, and cultural anthropology. Competence in statistics or a methodology relevant to the student's program of study must be demonstrated. Students are required to do original field, archival, or laboratory research that will result in a scholarly thesis.